



o my way of thinking, there may be miracles in religion but not in politics or economics. We succeeded because our people devoted their enterprising spirits. Conviction created indomitable efforts. This is the key to miracles”

The enterprising spirits and conviction that Chung Ju Yung—who founded the Hyundai Group and turned it into one of the world’s largest industrial conglomerates in a classic rags-to-riches story—talked about decades ago are exactly what Hyundai Motor India needs as it battles the toughest challenge it has faced in its 29 years in the country.

In FY25, Hyundai Motor India’s market share fell to 14%, the lowest since FY13. It slipped to the 4th spot in February and March 2025, behind Maruti Suzuki, Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra. The company got back to the 3rd spot in May and June but its overall trajectory is worrying; before this, it had been an undisputed number two ever since the 1998 launch of Hyundai Santro that revolutionised India’s small car market with its tall-boy design, spacious cabin and smart advertising featuring actor Shah Rukh Khan. In

the first quarter of FY26, the company’s sales declined 12% to 1,32,259 units, as against 1,49,455 units in the same period last year. In the first half of CY25, sales dipped 8% to 2,85,809 units, from 3,09,768 units in the same period last year.

Can Hyundai Motor India, led by Managing Director Unsoo Kim and Whole-time Director & COO Tarun Garg, do a Santro redux and race comfortably ahead of Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra, both of which are snapping at its heels? “Rather than market share alone, our focus has been on building a strong brand legacy anchored in delivering superior products, progressive technologies and seamless ownership experience. Our core philosophy of qualitative and sustainable growth drives every aspect of operations,” says Unsoo Kim.

Hyundai is playing the long game but can ill-afford

LOSING THE PLOT...

► In FY25, market share declined to 14%, its lowest since 2013

► Sales dipped 2.6% to 5,98,666 units, as against 6,14,721 units in FY24

► It slipped to the fourth spot in February and March,

behind Tata Motors and Mahindra & Mahindra

► Apart from Creta, the broader portfolio is struggling in a fiercely competitive market

► EV market share is 2.2%, less than Tata Motors, Mahindra & Mahindra, JSW MG Motor India, and even BYD

A Hyundai for every

Hyundai India’s IPO was the nation’s biggest; it raised ₹25,000 crore-plus



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